

Serious Git vulnerability revealed, but the patch is available!

The open source technology behind GitHub, Git, is under threat again. A new vulnerability has been identified and the patch for it was made available on December 18, 2014. The vulnerability is known as CVE-2014-9390, with which attackers have targeted Git clients using Windows and Mac OS X systems. It affects both servers and local machines.

The vulnerability was reported by the author of Mercurial, the open source version control system. An attacker can hack and use the Git tree to overwrite .git/config files while cloning the repository through this vulnerability. Developers have patched Git by releasing Git v2.2.1. Security researchers have confirmed that the vulnerability only affects Windows and Mac OS X users. The update has been patched in Mercurial version 3.2.3.

This is a client-side exploit, so attackers can breach a system only if they are trusted by the target or somehow manage to access a trusted system. The risk is very high as the malicious repository directly overwrites the local configuration file for Windows and OS X Git users.

Among the many security researchers who spotted this vulnerability was Tod Beardsley, the Metasploit engineering manager at Rapid7, who says that since Metasploit uses Git and GitHub, this vulnerability can have a serious impact on all the systems using such penetration-testing firmware. The Metasploit community uses Git on a regular basis.

If you are hosting a service from a Linux machine but your clients fetch the data to their Windows or Mac OSX machines, you must update the patch to ensure security. Git was developed by Linus Torvalds, creator of Linux OS. The blog post on GitHub warns all users to use the patch.



was discussed extensively in CES 2015, and the car that is powered by Android Auto was also be introduced. Google has not announced anything

officially though. The search giant has already entered into partnerships with Audi, Honda, GM, Hyundai, Nissan, etc, in order to create the Open Automotive License.

As soon as the ignition is turned on, Google's car services will be made available to users. So Google will now be able to use the car's camera, GPS system, etc, and may use all the information it collects thus for advertising purposes.

North Korea's Red Star Linux version 3 is out!

North Korea had introduced the Red Star Linux OS back in 2010 and it has now received a major update. Red Star is based on Red Hat's mainstream Linux distro. The Red Star version 3.0 comes with a brand new UI, which resembles the Mac OS X quite a lot.

When version 2 of Red Star was revealed in 2010, the user interface was similar to Windows 8.

The core apps, file manager, left side button, aqua style UI, apps dock and a whole lot else in the new version are inspired by Mac OS X. The OS has the flexibility to change the interface though. North Korea's design taste seems to have evolved over a period of five years. Red Star Linux was developed by the Korea Computer Centre (KCC), which is one of the major software programming centres in Pyongyang. North Korean developers have always been more focused on the propaganda value of the software than its usability. They could have released the Red Star Linux v3.0 in multiple languages, yet have limited it to Korean.

As of now, the new version is not available for download to the public. However, someone has uploaded a leaked copy on Torrents.

WordPress v4.1 is out

The popular open source blogging and CMS (content management system) platform, WordPress, released v4.1 on December 18 last year. WordPress v4.1 brings out a number of new features and an enhanced user interface. The version release has been named Dinah Washington, after the famous Jazz musician.

WordPress developers have focused on enabling distraction-free writing in this update. The highly advanced writing mode offers an optimised application interface, which clears the clutter of tools from the screen to make it as blank as possible but, at the same time, all the necessary writing and editing tools are easily accessible.

The release note states, "We have removed all the distraction to let

